

Severe bleeding

ACTION CHECKLIST

Call emergency services and press firmly directly on the bleeding wound with a dressing or clean cloth. Maintain pressure. For life-threatening bleeding from an arm or leg, use a commercial tourniquet if trained; follow dispatcher instructions.

[] **Protect and call**

Check scene safety, use gloves if available and get emergency help.

[] **Apply direct pressure**

Press firmly over the wound and keep pressing until bleeding stops or appropriate help takes over.

[] **Use trained techniques**

Use a tourniquet or wound packing for the appropriate injury if trained, following the device and dispatcher instructions.

[] **Monitor the person**

Keep them from getting cold, check breathing and remain until responders arrive.

WATCH FOR

Do not pull an embedded object out; press around it and get help.

Updated 2026-10-02 | General guidance. Follow current local instructions. In immediate danger, contact emergency services.

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/severe-bleeding/>

Severe bleeding · official guidance